

1. Executive Summary

This report is about the heritage significance of the War Memorial Hospital site in Waverley.

In Sections Three, Four and Five, a detailed examination of the site and its history is presented, and conclusions drawn to define the heritage significance of the site in this way-

Donated to the Methodists by the Vickery family as a memorial to Ebenezer Vickery Jr, the place is an outstanding representative example of private philanthropy and the 20th century conversion of Victorian estates to institutional uses.

The War Memorial Hospital, established in 1922 by the Methodist Church as a memorial to the First World War, occupies the buildings and grounds of the former Edina estate, which is aesthetically and historically significant as a suburban Victorian estate that retains its spatial order, scale and planning, as well as four very good Victorian houses, three of which form a significant streetscape along a rare private streetscape. The Victorian landscape planning is overlaid by a 1920s landscape of significance in its own right, as are the 1930s hospital chapel and main wing.

The site's mansion tower and Norfolk Island pines have landscape urban significance as landmarks within the broader surrounding area.

After an examination in Section Six of the opportunities and constraints that arise from this significance, and the needs of the owners, policies for conserving that significance are presented in Section seven. The policies address

- Conserving the single estate character and its main landscape spaces and landmark trees;
- Preserving the Victorian Buildings, Main Hospital Building and Chapel and the important garden spaces;
- Reconstruction of the main driveway sequence, or approximation thereof;
- Developing parts of the site to extend its historic use as a unified place of care.